

Chapter One – The Healing Sage

Nestled deep within the Emerald Mist Mountains stood the secluded **GNS Clan**, hidden among towering pines and drifting clouds. Few in the Jianghu knew its true location, and fewer still could find it. The clan had long remained neutral in the affairs of the martial world, devoting itself to the pursuit of medicine, compassion, and righteous martial arts.

Its leader was known throughout the Jianghu as **Master GNS**.

Although she had withdrawn from worldly affairs decades ago, her name remained legendary. Countless martial artists, nobles, and even imperial officials had once crossed mountains and rivers seeking her aid. She was revered as the greatest physician of her generation, a healer whose medical knowledge could pull a dying man back from the gates of the Underworld.

Yet her fame did not rest upon medicine alone.

Master GNS was the sole living inheritor of the legendary **Buddha Palm Technique**, a martial art said to embody both overwhelming power and boundless mercy. While a single palm strike could disperse the fiercest internal qi without taking a life, its highest realm allowed the practitioner to stabilize shattered meridians, mend damaged internal organs, and preserve those whom others had already declared beyond saving.

Few had ever witnessed the technique.

Those who had spoke of it with reverence.

As Heka hurried through the stone gates carrying the unconscious stranger on her shoulder, several junior disciples rushed forward in alarm.

"Second Senior Sister!"

"What happened?"



"Who is he?"

Heka shook her head.

"I found him unconscious by the river after the waterfall. His injuries are extremely severe. Inform Master immediately."

One of the disciples immediately ran toward the inner courtyard.

Moments later, the doors of a quiet bamboo hall slowly opened.

A graceful woman stepped outside.

Though her long hair was as white as fresh snow, her face retained a timeless elegance. She wore flowing ivory robes embroidered with golden lotus blossoms, and every step she took radiated calm authority. Her eyes were gentle, yet within them rested the profound wisdom of someone who had lived through countless storms.

She was ****Master GNS****, the Matriarch of the GNS Clan.

Without wasting a moment, she knelt beside the unconscious man.

Her fingers rested lightly upon his wrist as she examined his pulse.

Silence filled the courtyard.

After several breaths, her expression became grave.

"Sword wounds... hidden weapon injuries... exhausted meridians..."

Her fingers moved to the back of his head.

There, beneath the blood-matted hair, she discovered a deep wound.

Her brows knitted together.

"He struck his head against the rocks after falling into the waterfall."

"The impact has caused severe trauma."

Heka's heart tightened.

"Master... can he still be saved?"

Master GNS remained silent for a moment before answering.

"His body has endured far beyond the limits of an ordinary martial artist."

"He should have died long before reaching this place."

She slowly nodded.

"Yet his life force still burns."

"There is hope."

She looked toward her disciples.

"Prepare the Golden Lotus Healing Paste."

"Yes, Master."

"Boil the Seven-Herb Vitality Decoction."

"Immediately."

"Bring my jade acupuncture case."

The disciples hurried to obey.

Master GNS carefully removed the blood-soaked robes covering the stranger's upper body.

The disciples gasped.

Old scars crisscrossed his body, evidence of years spent wandering the martial world.

Fresh wounds covered nearly every inch of his skin.

Several throwing daggers had narrowly missed his vital meridians by less than half an inch.

Most alarming of all was the swelling at the back of his skull.

"He survived the waterfall..."

One disciple whispered.

"...only to be struck by the rocks beneath."

Master GNS opened a carved jade case and withdrew a set of silver acupuncture needles.



With movements so swift and precise they were almost impossible to follow, she inserted one hundred and eight needles into the man's major acupoints.

Each needle sealed a damaged meridian while preventing his remaining qi from dissipating.

The stranger's body trembled violently.

Moments later, Master GNS raised her right palm.

A warm golden light gradually enveloped her hand.

The surrounding disciples instinctively stepped back.

"The Buddha Palm..."

Heka whispered.

Golden qi flowed gently from Master GNS's palm into the stranger's body.

Unlike ordinary internal energy, it neither forced nor overwhelmed.

Instead, it soothed.

Broken meridians slowly stabilized.

Chaotic qi returned to a steady flow.

The damaged organs ceased deteriorating.

Most importantly, the golden qi protected the man's heart and nourished the injured pathways leading to his brain, giving his body a chance to recover from the devastating head injury.

The treatment continued for nearly three hours.

When Master GNS finally withdrew her hand, beads of perspiration glistened upon her forehead.

She exhaled softly.

"I have preserved his life."

Relief spread across Heka's face.

"But..."

Master GNS's gaze lingered upon the unconscious stranger.

"The injury to his head is severe."

"He may sleep for days..."

"...perhaps even longer."

"Whether he awakens..."

"...depends on his own will."

Only then did Master GNS notice that even in unconsciousness, the stranger's fingers remained tightly wrapped around the black cloth bundle he had protected with his life.

Heka gently loosened his grip and placed the bundle beside the bed.

Neither master nor disciple attempted to open it.

Whatever secret it contained...

It had already cost countless lives.

Outside, the mountain breeze whispered through the bamboo grove.

Far beyond the secluded valley, five hooded assassins continued searching the rivers and forests below the waterfall.

They believed the stranger had died.

None of them knew...

...that destiny had already carried him into the care of the greatest healer in all the Jianghu.